

We make our living based on the fact that people buy these games, but it still feels a bit too high even while knowing this contributes to our paycheck...

On the other hand, the lowest-end model of the Xbox 360 retails at Rs. 15,000, with some packages throwing in an extra wireless controller. The wireless controller will set you back by just Rs. 2,250. A slight digression – we recommend that if you are buying a second wireless controller, you buy one for Windows PCs. These controllers are fully compatible with the Xbox 360 and with the receiver, you will also be able to use them to play games on your PC.

Getting back to the price war, the Xbox 360's games cost somewhere around the Rs. 1,900 mark for each title. With a single title each month, the cost still comes to Rs. 40,300 – significantly lower than that of the PS3. And with two titles a month, that cost goes up to around Rs. 63,100.

In terms of value for money, the Xbox 360 wins hands down.

Game titles

Exclusivity of video game titles has become an integral part of the allure of consoles. It is no longer enough to just look at the price or the features; you also need to know which games you will be getting and which ones you will be missing out on.

The Xbox 360's big exclusive titles include the likes of *Halo*, *Gears of War*, *Project Gotham Racing*, *Fable*, *Assassin's Creed*, etc. In the upcoming list of big games, UbiSoft has decided that *Splinter Cell: Conviction* will be playable only on the 360, giving a massive boost to the console. Valve has also made its disgust for the PS3 known by signing an exclusivity contract with Microsoft for *Left4Dead 2*.

The PlayStation 3, on the other hand, has some great exclusive franchises on its hands, such as *God of War*, *Resistance*, *KillZone 2*, *Heavenly Sword*, *Gran Turismo*, *Formula One*, *Uncharted: Drake's Fortune*, etc.

The big blow to the PS3's campaign, however, came when Kojima Productions announced that the next iteration of its Metal Gear Solid franchise would no longer be a PlayStation-exclusive. The PS3 has long been almost synonymous with the *Metal Gear Solid* series, and the departure of a trusted ally like Kojima does not bode well for Sony.

In this list, it is really up to you as to which set of titles sounds better to you. In terms of future-proofing yourself, the Xbox 360 is a safer bet with a lot of developers not happy with the PS3 for various reasons. Even if they do decide to make games for the console, the idea of PS3 exclusivity does not sound like it's going to be something the publishers jump at.

2.6.3 FOR MORE THAN GAMING

When you think of buying a video game, do you intend to use it just for gaming? The PlayStation 3 and the Xbox 360 can do a lot more than just play games, and in fact, are great replacements for DVD players or other multimedia add-ons to your entertainment system.